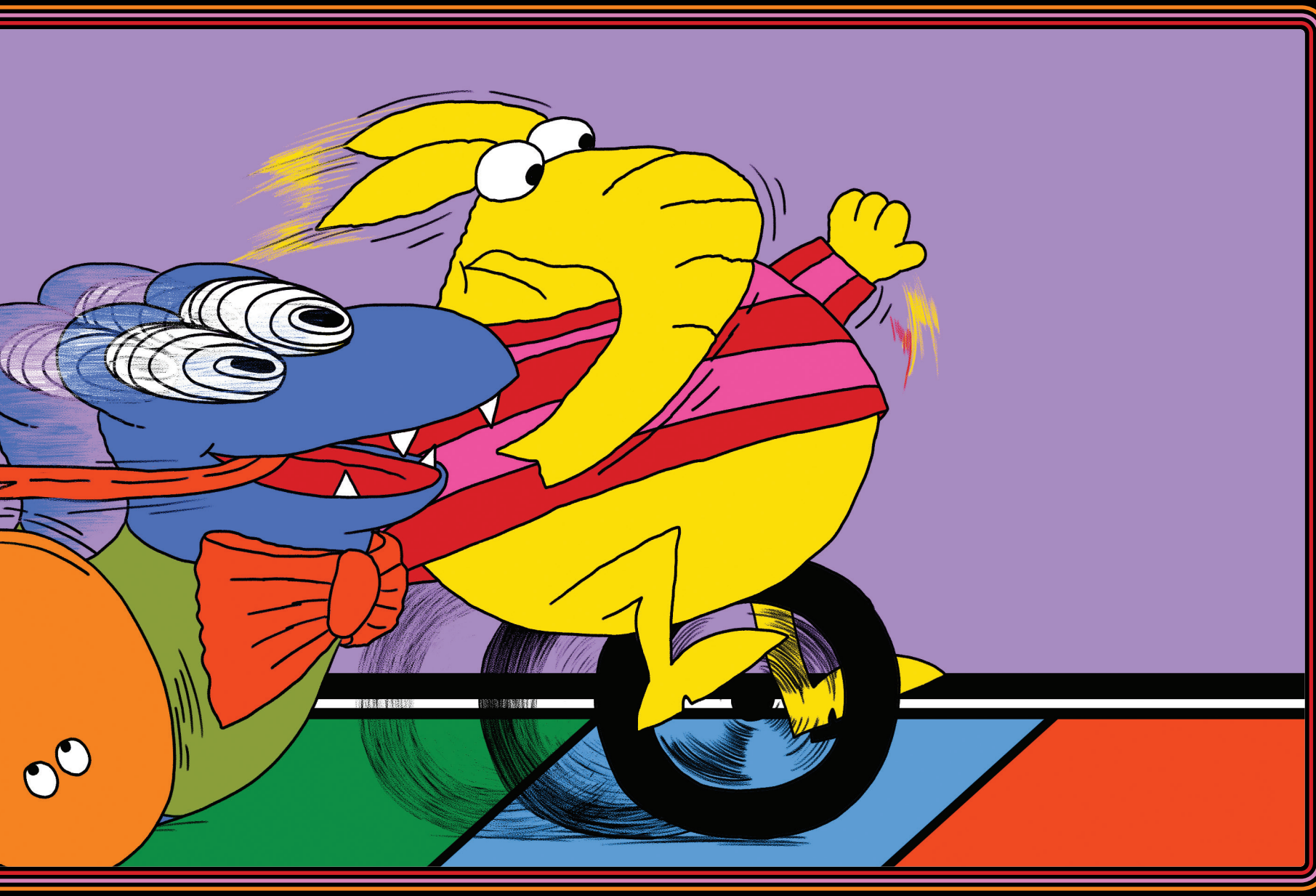
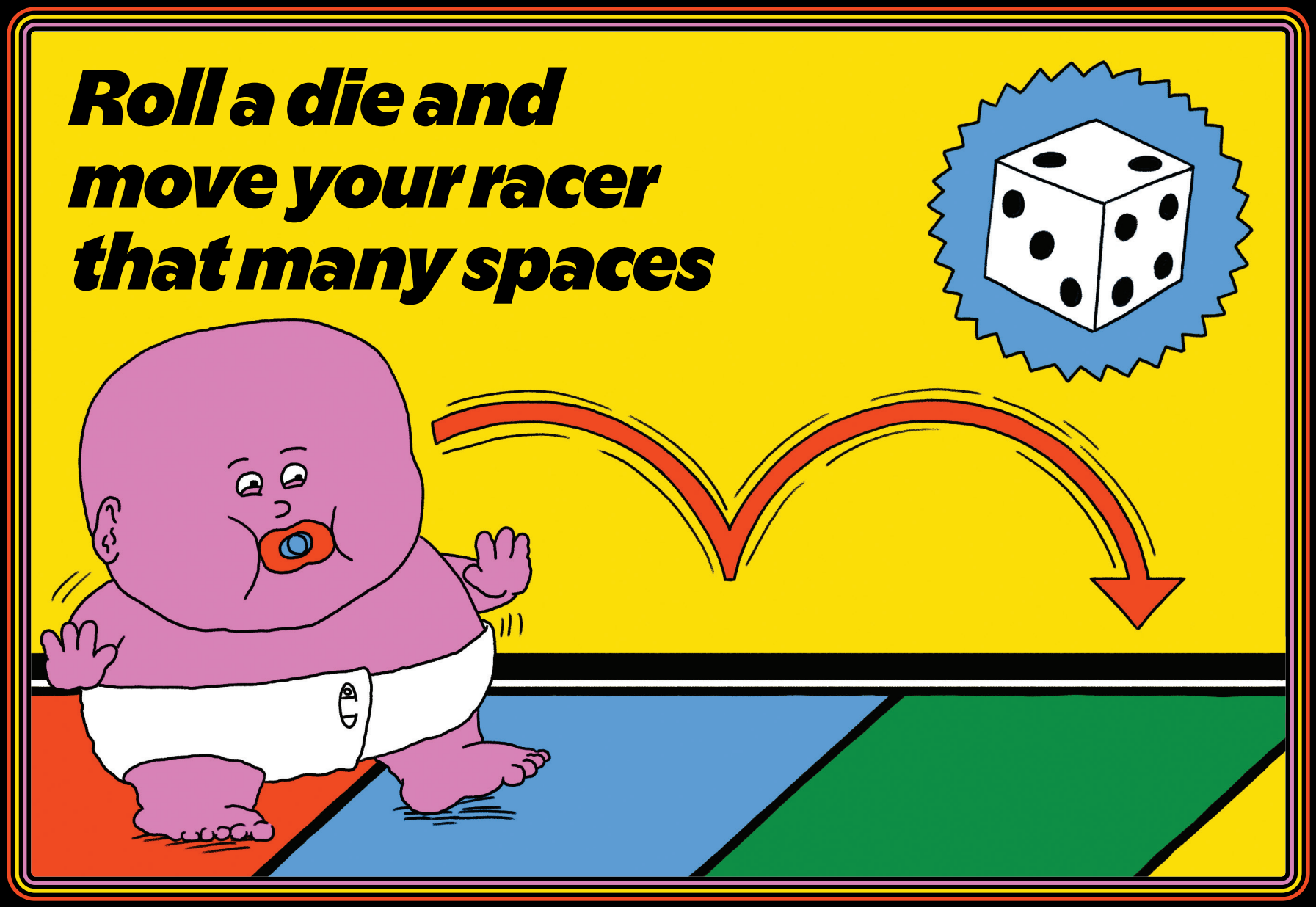
MAGICAL ATHLETE

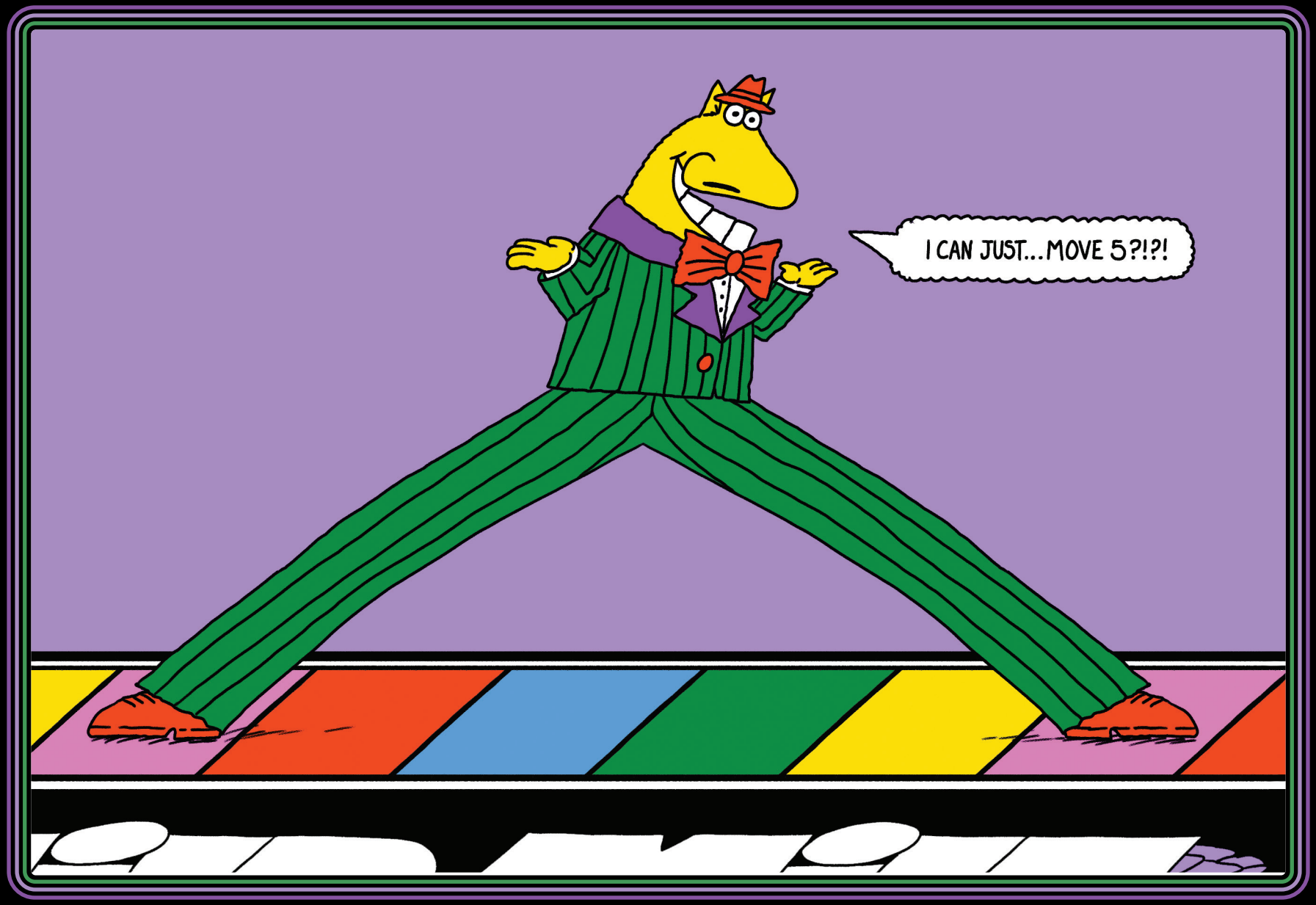
Magical Athlete
is a racing game
of pure chaos!

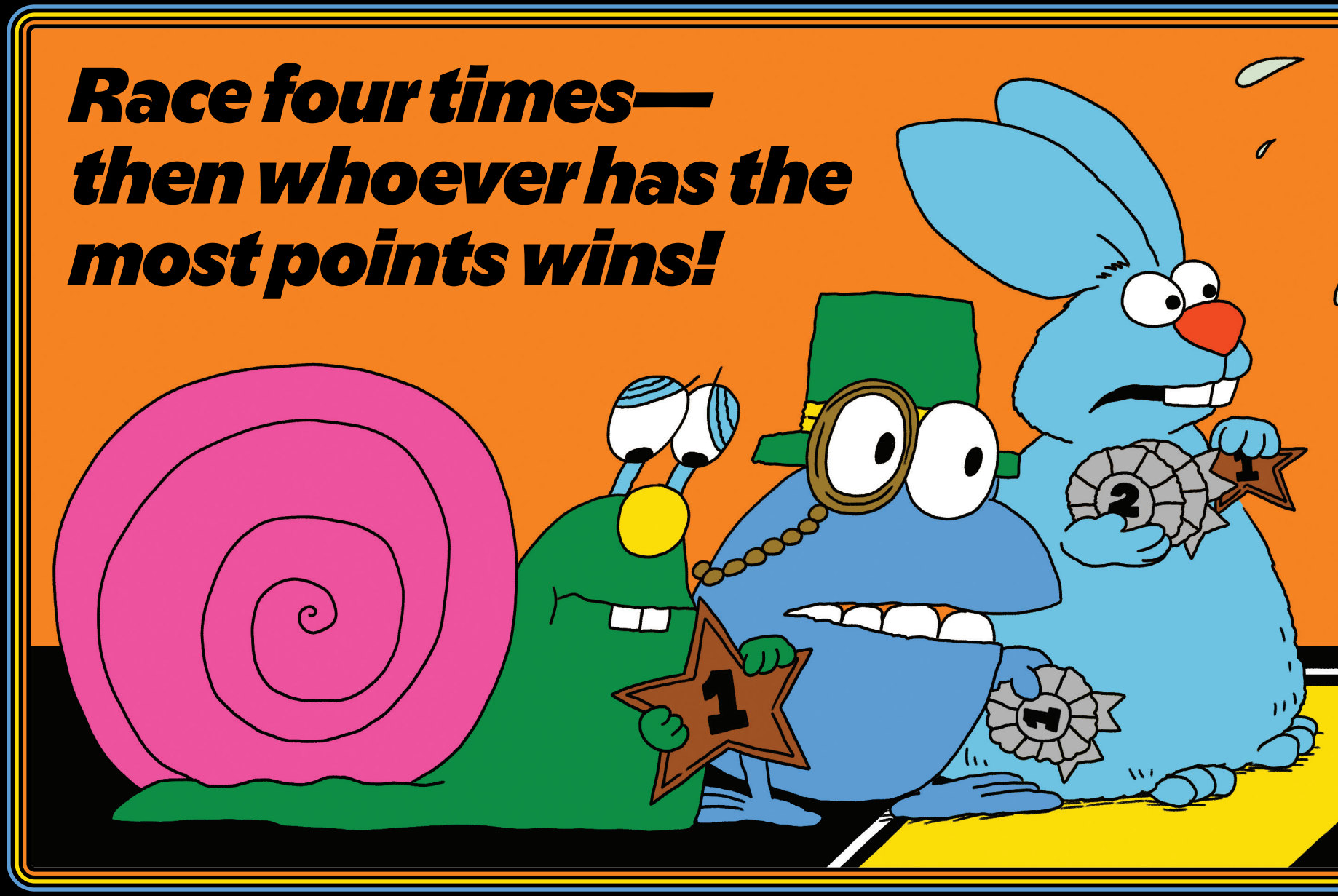



Roll a die and
move your racer
that many spaces

But all the racers have wacky, game-breaking abilities
I SKIP SPACES WITH OTHER RACERS ON THEM!

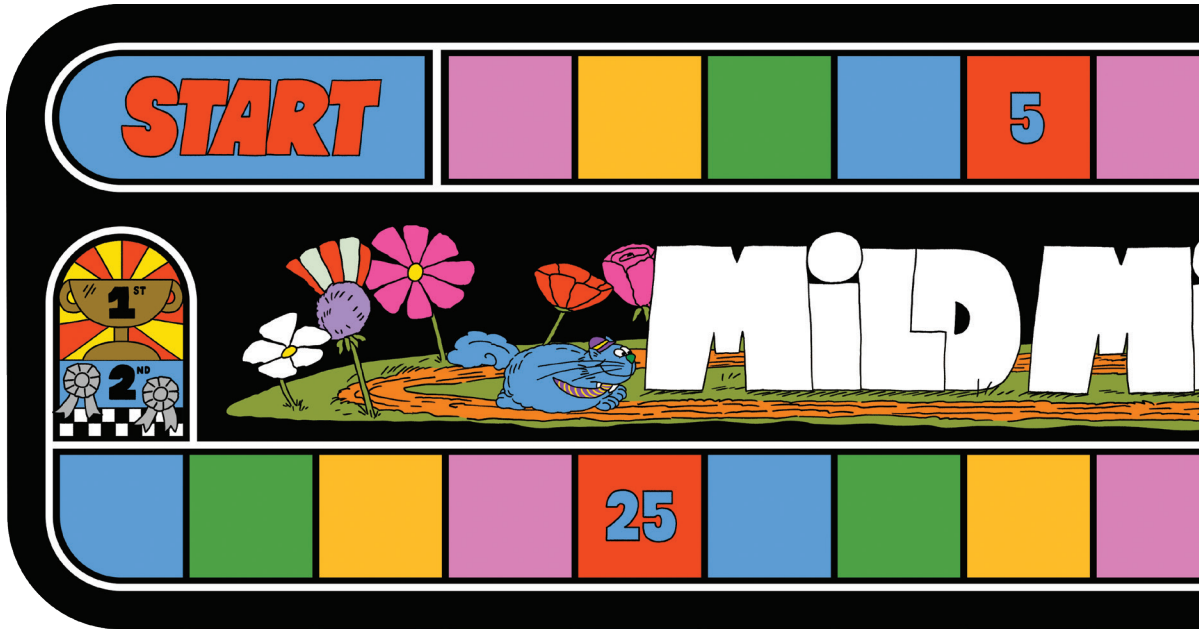
I KICK RACERS BACKWARDS WHEN I PASS THEM


I CAN JUST...MOVE 5?!?!


Race four times—
then whoever has the
most points wins!
1
2
1
3

5
4
3
2

01



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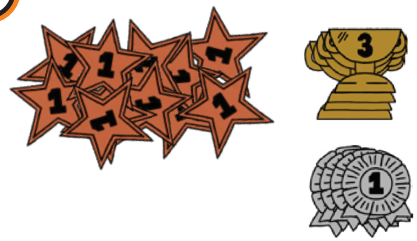


03

04

SETUP

01 Put the racetrack in the middle of the table, Mild Mile side up.

02 Dump out the bag of point chips. Stack the gold trophy and silver rosette point chips in order, biggest on the bottom.

03 Keep the shuffled racer deck nearby.

04 Dump out the bag of racers.

05 Give everyone a die.

RECRUIT YOUR TEAM

To start, everyone drafts a team of 4 racers that they'll use for the entire game, one racer per race.

Flip up twice as many racer cards as there are players and put them in a line in the middle of the table.

3 PLAYERS → FLIP 6 CARDS
4 PLAYERS → FLIP 8 CARDS
5 PLAYERS → FLIP 10 CARDS
6 PLAYERS → FLIP 12 CARDS

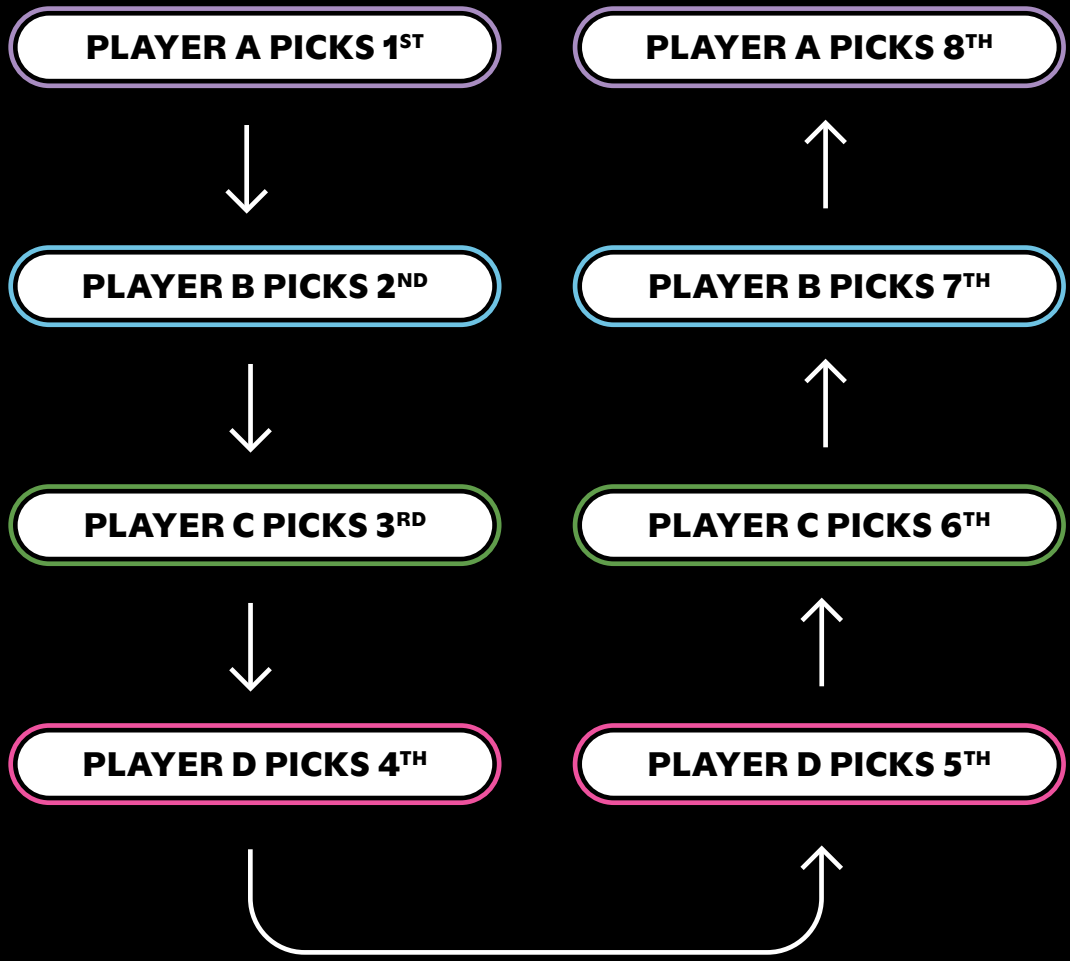
★ *Racing with only 2 players? See page 28.*

Now roll off! Everyone rolls their die. Whoever rolls highest drafts first! If there's a tie, the player with the next highest roll drafts first. If everyone ties, reroll.

Going clockwise, everyone picks a racer. When the last player picks, reverse the draft order: the last player picks a second racer, and now go counterclockwise until everyone has two racers. That's right, it's a snake draft!

Repeat this process, starting with the player to the left of the start player. That's right, it's a second snake draft! Now everybody has 4 racers total and you're ready to race.

(If all this drafting business sounds too complicated, or if you have a lot of new players, for your first game just deal everyone 4 random racers and learn on the fly. Or deal 6 and pick 4. Or do the draft, but put out the racers instead of the cards, and let people decide entirely on vibes!)


PLAYER A PICKS 1ST
PLAYER B PICKS 2ND
PLAYER C PICKS 3RD
PLAYER D PICKS 4TH
PLAYER D PICKS 5TH
PLAYER C PICKS 6TH
PLAYER B PICKS 7TH
PLAYER A PICKS 8TH

RACE!

Before the first race, roll off exactly like you did for the draft. Whoever wins goes first. Everyone picks a racer card from their hand and reveals it at the same time. You can only use each racer once, and later races are worth more points, so you might want to save your best racers for the end. Everyone takes their racer token from the pile and puts it onto the Start space.

Races are simple: players take turns rolling their dice, moving their racers, and watching the chaos unfold as powers trigger!

On your turn, roll your die and move that many spaces on the track. That's called your **main move**. That's a concept that's so important that we put it in bold and underlined it. A lot of powers trigger off the main move specifically, so keep an eye out for that wording, since racers can move in lots of other ways than their **main moves**.

After a player finishes their turn, the next player goes in clockwise order. Keep going until two racers cross the finish line. The first across takes 1st place, and when the second across takes 2nd place, the race ends immediately.

If a power ever says you CAN use it, it's optional. All other powers are mandatory!

A racer's power can take effect when a player chooses to use it, when a trigger occurs, or just passively. If multiple powers need to take effect at the same time, they activate in this order:

RACETRACK SPACES → **CURRENT PLAYER** → **OTHER PLAYERS**
(Going clockwise)

EXAMPLE

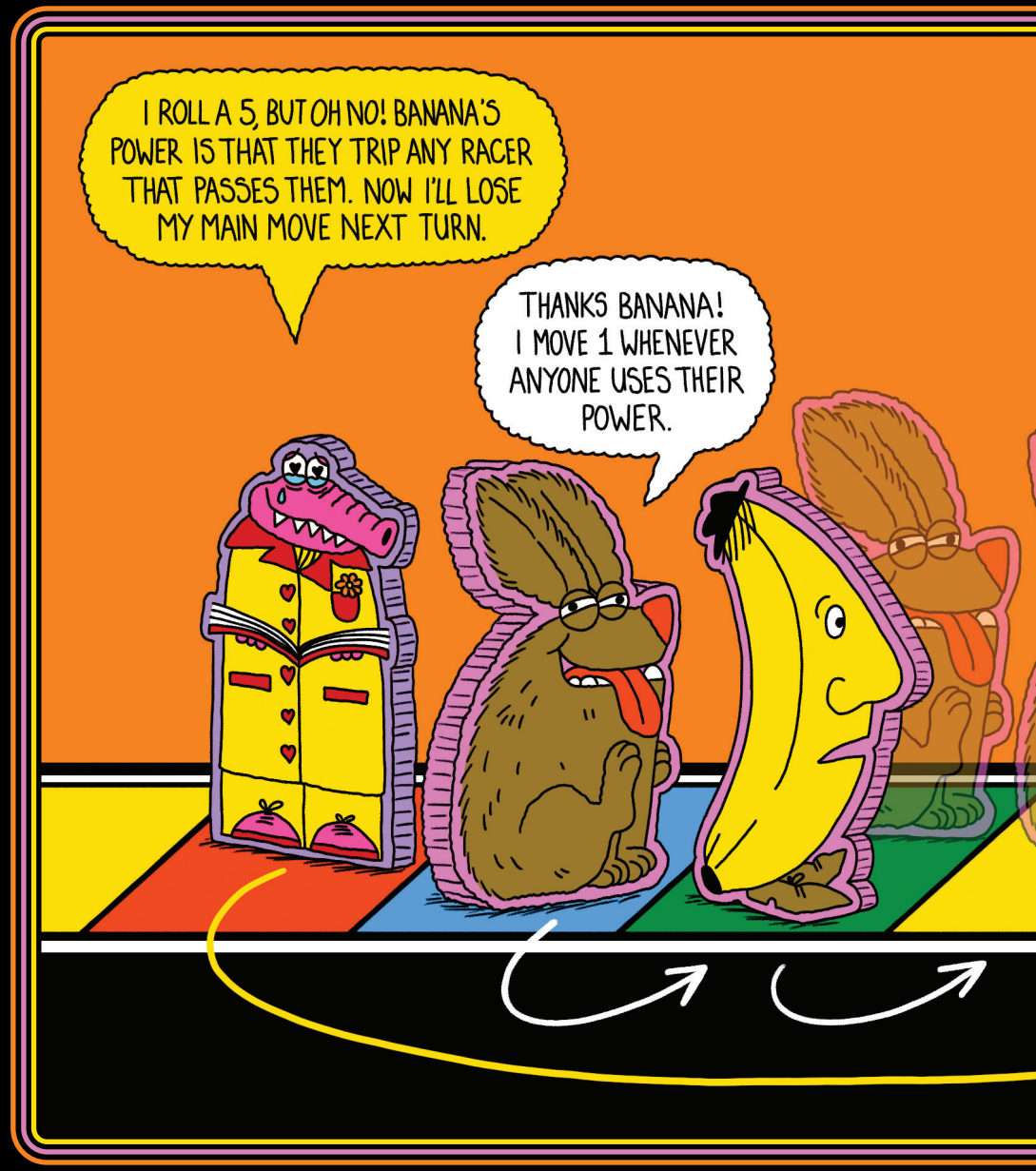
It's the Romantic's turn, and they roll a 5 for their main move. While they move 5 spaces, they pass Scoocher and Banana.

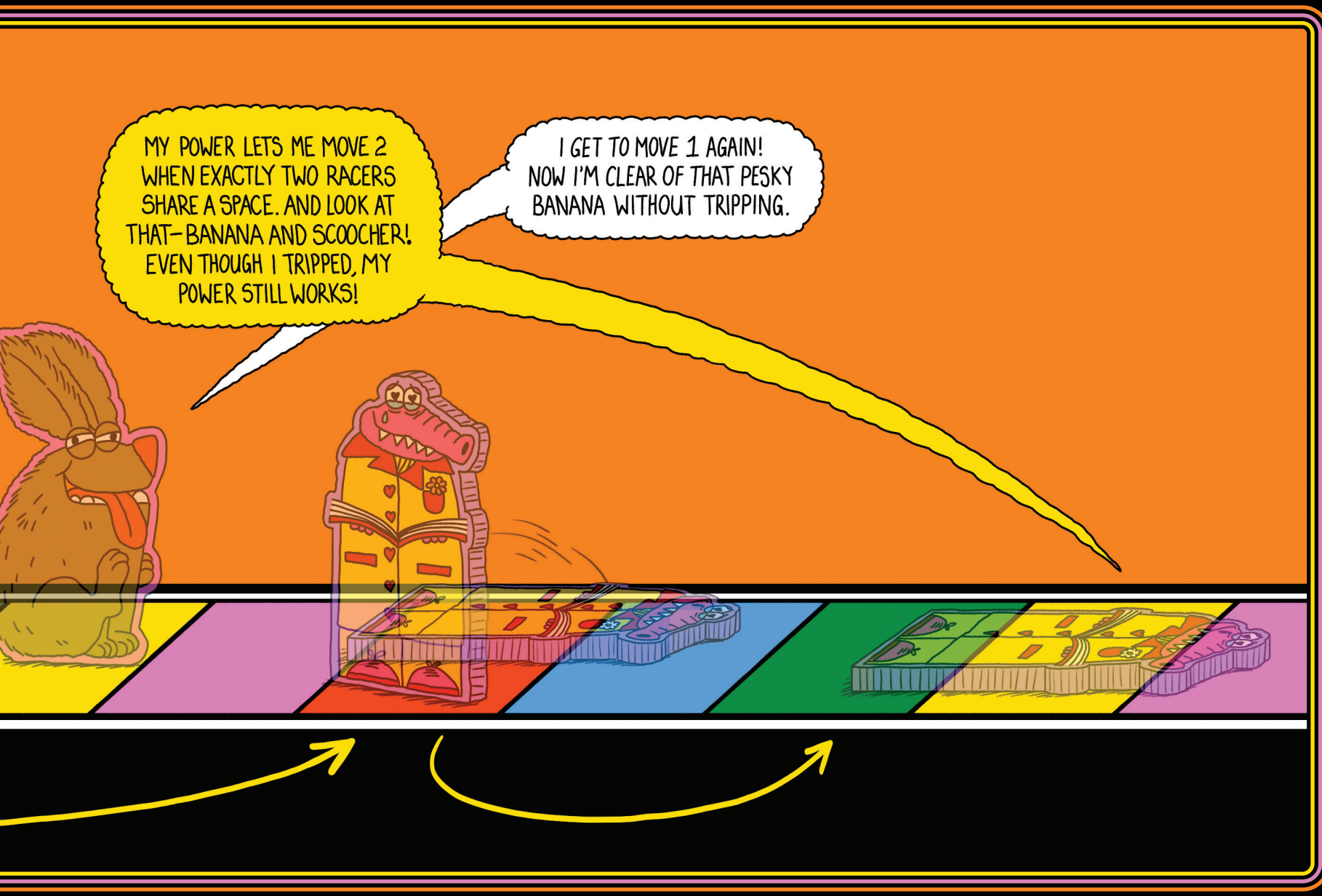
Banana's power is to trip any racer that passes them, so after the Romantic finishes their full main move, they trip! That means they skip their next main move.

Scoocher is thrilled, because their power is moving 1 whenever anyone's power happens. So they move 1 and stop on the same space as Banana.

Now the Romantic is thrilled, because their power is that when exactly 2 racers are stopped on a space, they get to move 2. Even though they're tripped, they can still use their power.

Of course, since another power is triggered, Scoocher moves another 1.




MY POWER LETS ME MOVE 2 WHEN EXACTLY TWO RACERS SHARE A SPACE. AND LOOK AT THAT– BANANA AND SCOOCHER! EVEN THOUGH I TRIPPED, MY POWER STILL WORKS!
I GET TO MOVE 1 AGAIN! NOW I'M CLEAR OF THAT PESKY BANANA WITHOUT TRIPPING.

AFTER THE RACE

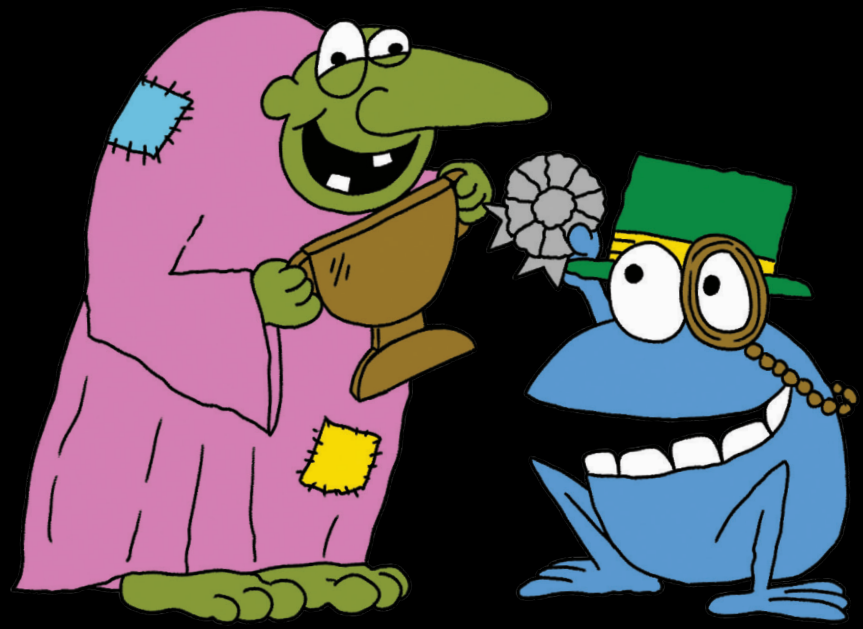
As soon as the 2nd place racer finishes, the race ends! The 1st place racer takes the top gold chip from the pile. The 2nd place racer takes the top silver. Then...

01 **Take all the cards and racer tokens from the race and put them out of play.**

02 **Flip the track over to the other side. (You'll race on each track twice per game: Mild, Wild, Mild, Wild.)**

★ *If you prefer, you can race all on a single track, or change the schedule to your liking. Just decide before you start the game so you can strategize around it.*

03 **Everyone simultaneously reveals a new racer card and puts that racer token on the Start space. The player with the farthest behind (or first eliminated) racer in the last race goes first in the next race.**



FINAL SCORING

When the fourth race ends, the game is over. Whoever has the most points wins!

If there's a tie, there's a tie: celebrate together!

COMBINING BOXES

There's more than one Magical Athlete box! All of them are designed to work great as standalone games, but the true sickos out there mix them together.

If you do, race on different tracks each race. So if you have the original Magical Athlete and Second Wind, race in this order: Mild Mile, Wild Wilds, Twisty Twirl, Whirly World.

MAGICAL ATHLETE
MAGICAL ATHLETE

FIDDLY DETAILS

Magical Athlete is a simple game, but the interactions can get wild! It helps to know a few key concepts. But don't stress—most of this will come up naturally as you play.

To the right, you'll find a quick guide to important terms, what happens on the track, and how certain racers work. If something unexpected happens, check here or just roll with it. Embrace the chaos and rules discussions—it's all part of the fun!

Usually whoever owns the game can be a gentle rules referee. And if you're ever completely stumped, roll off to decide who's right.

TERMS

Ahead/Behind:
Racers are ahead of another racer if they're stopped on a space closer to the finish line. Racers are behind another racer if they are stopped on a space closer to the Start space. If racers share a space, they're neither ahead nor behind each other.

Alone:
When a racer isn't sharing their space.

Last place:
The racer(s) currently closest to the Start space.

Lead:
The racer(s) currently closest to the finish line. This doesn't count racers who have already crossed the finish line.

Main move:
The action you always get on your turn, where you roll your die and move that many spaces.

Move:
When a racer changes spaces from their **main move**, powers, or any other situation that specifically uses the word "move." If a racer ever needs to "move 0," that doesn't count as moving for the purposes of triggering other powers based on movement.

Passing:
When a racer starts a move behind a racer and ends the same move ahead of them. (Or if they're moving backwards, they start ahead and end behind!)

Sharing a space:
Racers are "on" a space with another racer when both are currently stopped on that space. In other words, if racers temporarily occupy the same space over the course of moving, warping, etc.—that doesn't count!

Space:
The squares beginning with the Start space and ending at the finish line. The Start space counts as a space! Anything past the finish line doesn't.

Stopping on a space:
Racers are stopped on a space after they've finished moving onto it, or otherwise arriving there by other means, like through Flip Flop's warping power.

Trip:
A tripped racer skips their next **main move**! You don't even roll your die, though your powers can still trigger and you can still move in other ways. When you trip, finish your move completely, then lay your racer token face down. On your next main move, put your token back upright to indicate you've recovered. And remember: tripping doesn't end your current move prematurely!

Warp:
When a racer warps, put their token on the new space, but don't count it as "moving" for triggering powers, passing racers, etc.

TRACK INFO

Arrows:

When you stop on a space with an arrow, move the number of spaces shown in the arrow's direction. This counts as a separate move than how you got there, and never part of your main move, if it matters.

Trip:

When you stop on a space that says TRIP, you trip!

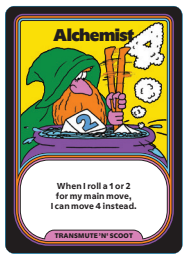
Star:

When you stop on a space with a star, take a bronze 1 point chip.

FIDDLY DETAILS

1. If you reroll for any reason, treat the previous number you rolled as if it never happened. The reroll action itself can still trigger powers like Scoocher.
2. Powers involving stopping on a space together don't trigger if racers arrive at the same time.
3. Powers that happen at a specific time, like "At the start of my turn," only happen once per turn.
4. Racer powers deactivate after they finish or leave a race, unless otherwise stated.
5. If you run into an infinite loop, complete it once in order, then stop. Some powers can interact many times but aren't a loop, like Scoocher/Suckerfish. If you ever enter a loop where no one can finish or move at all, the race ends immediately: no one gets the remaining points unless they've already finished.
6. If there is ever only one racer left, the race ends immediately, and that racer gets first or second, whichever applies.
7. If multiple powers change the value of a move—like Rocket Scientist and Gunk—resolve in turn order.
8. If there's a tie for the lead or last place, and a power like Copy Cat's would target them, they pick which to target.
9. When racing with multiple racers, set them in front of you in the order you want them to take their turn, going clockwise.

RACER INFO



Alchemist

Forever seeking the ancient secret of turning This into That.

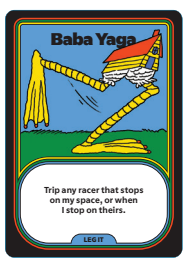
Blimp

Built to fly, born to explode.

Coach

Believing in yourself is even more important when you are some kind of lizard.

I get my power's benefit too!



Baba Yaga

This property is going fast.

If I share a space with the Duelist, we can duel, but the Duelist will still trip.

The Hypnotist can cast their spell on me, but they still trip.

Centaur

Here's the kicker.

A racer can't be hoofwhacked any farther back than the Start space.

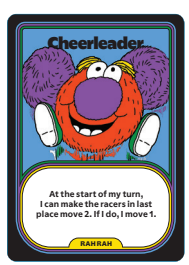
Copy Cat

Very similar to another, different cat.

I persistently have the power of the lead racer, not just on my turn. If there's ever a contradiction between me and the racer I'm copying, their power takes priority. I never copy "before my race" powers. If there's a tied lead, I can't switch my power mid-action.

Banana

No more edible than you or I.



Cheerleader

A being of pure pep.

If there is more than one racer in last place, they all move. But I only move 1 regardless of how many racers are in last.

If I cheer for myself, those are two separate moves: move 2 then move 1.

Dicemonger

He picked his career from a d100 table.

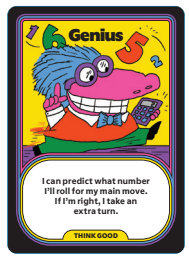
If someone else rerolls,
I move before they move.

Duelist

When you've got a rapier, everything looks like a duel.

I can duel multiple times in a turn, including when it's not my turn. I just need to be sharing a space to immediately declare a duel.

I can't interrupt actions in progress, like between a roll and a move.



Genius

And yet a fool in the ways of love.

If I'm racing against Skipper and I predict a 1, Skipper steals the next turn, since their power triggers after mine.

When playing with multiple racers, if I predict right, I get an extra turn but not my other racer(s).

Heckler

It's constructive criticism.

My power works for racers recovering from tripping.

Egg

You should see the chicken.

You should still use my racer token!

I still get any "before race" powers.

Gunk

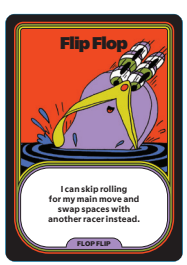
A bit of a hugger.

My goop reduces the move amount, not the die roll number. So it doesn't make a 6 into a 5 and keep the Lackey from doing their job.

Huge Baby

She's 30.

I'm a unique case: when other racers are put behind me because of my power, that doesn't count as a move: it's like they just stopped on that space instead. If I stop on Banana's space and move them back, it counts as passing them and I trip.



Flip Flop

Ever searching for its lost twin.

My flop flip is a warp: it doesn't count as a move and I don't roll.

I never occupy the same space as a racer I switch places with. We flop flip simultaneously.

Hare

The only thing he can't outrun is hubris.

Hypnotist

Implanted this false bio himself.

RACER INFO

Inchworm

Give her an inch and she'll take an inch.

If another racer rolls a 1 and the Skipper is also on the track with me, I wriggle 1 and then the Skipper takes their turn.

Legs

Has arms, too, but who cares.

My power counts as my main move, so can be gooped by Gunk or get the hustle bonus from Coach.

Mastermind

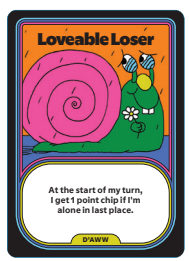
The one scheme he can't pull off is getting his parents back together.

If I predict myself, I can win both 1st and 2nd.

Lackey

If you're happy, he's happy.

I do my move before the other racer, if it matters.



Loveable Loser

Top of her class at Loser Academy. Which is bad.

M.O.U.T.H.

Mastication Orifice Utilized Toward Hunger.

Leaptoad

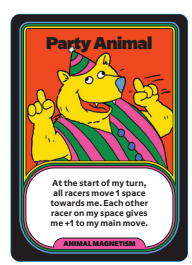
Frequently seen from below.

Yes, even if I'm moving backwards.

Magician

He can also cast fireball.

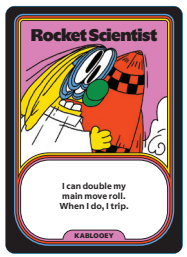
I must use whatever my last roll is.



Party Animal

They put a hat on an animal and this happened.

If Huge Baby parties onto my space, everyone there gets put 1 space back.



Rocket Scientist

Moonlights as a brain surgeon.

I roll THEN decide whether to kablooey.

Sisyphus

Stays humble, keeps grinding.

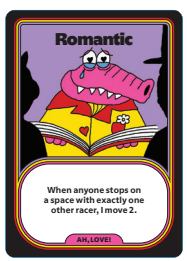
If I roll more than 4 sixes, I continue to lose points, assuming I have any.

I don't get my main move after warping.

Suckerfish

Has abandonment issues.

If I start moving with a racer, I can't stop until they finish their full move. I can cross the finish line using my power. I arrive at the space at the same time, but for finishing and triggering powers, the racer I'm moving with resolves first.



Romantic

The last of her species.

If two racers move together simultaneously, like with the Party Animal or Suckerfish, my power doesn't trigger.

Skipper

The wheel is fake, he just goes forward like everyone else.

After I go, turn order continues to my left. (Unless I roll a 1 and go again!)

Third Wheel

Searching for her throther half.

I still get my main move after warping.

Scoocher

Ope, just gonna scooch by you there.

When Gunk is on the board, I scooch 1 for every -1 that affects a racer's main move. With Dicemonger, I move for each reroll. With Leaptoad, I move for each space skipped. If they jumpfrog over 2 consecutive occupied spaces, I move 1 twice. I scooch 1 on each Magician reroll, even if it's not used.

Stickler

Proofread this rulebook without asking.

This includes any movement from main moves, powers, etc. For example, if the Duelist wins a duel on the final space before the finish line, they don't cross.

Twin

Not related to anyone, just identical to everyone.

You should still use my racer token!

I still get any "before race" powers.

2 PLAYER VARIANT

The rules are the same, except...

Recruiting:

Make a line of 8 faceup racers from the deck and snake draft them (Players A and B would have a draft order like this: ABBAABBA) Do it again with 8 more racers from the deck, in reverse order, until both players have 8 racers (16 total between both of you).

Preparing:

Both players simultaneously pick 2 different racers for each race, so 4 racers will be on the track to start. Each player also takes two dice to use for their different racers.

Racing:

When a player goes, they take turns with both of their racers, in clockwise order (set their order when you reveal them). Just be sure to complete the first racer's turn before moving onto the next. If you have racer powers that trigger when "other racers" do something, that includes your second racer.

After the first race, the player who received the lower number of points in the last race goes first. If tied, roll off!

3 PLAYER DOUBLE RACER VARIANT

The rules are the same, except...

Recruiting:

Make a line of 6 faceup racers from the deck and snake draft them like normal. Do that 4 times, rotating who drafts first. Everyone should have 8 racers after this.

Preparing:

All players simultaneously pick 2 different racers for each race, so 6 racers will be on the track to start. Each player also takes two dice to use for their different racers.

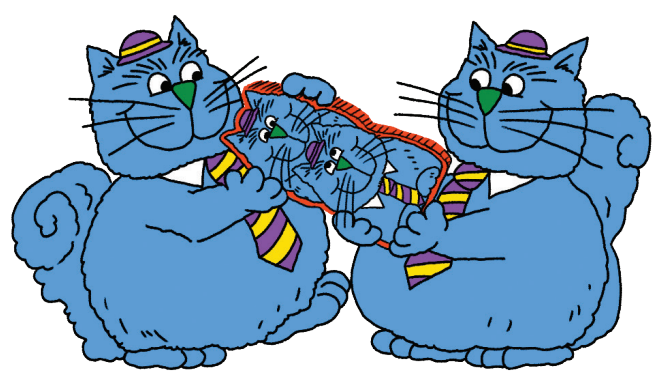
Racing:

When a player goes, they take turns with both of their racers, in clockwise order (set their order when you reveal them). Just be sure to complete the first racer's turn before moving onto the next. If you have racer powers that trigger when "other racers" do something, that includes your second racer.

After the first race, the player who received the lower number of points in the last race goes first. If tied, roll off!

FINAL THOUGHT

This game is now yours! If there are racers you don't like, don't play with them. If you have a racer idea, try it! Don't worry about breaking the game: it was designed to be broken. Have fun!



CONTENTS & CREDITS

Contents

- 1 double sided racetrack
- 36 racers
- 36 racer cards
- 6 dice
- 4 gold 1st place chips
- 4 silver 2nd place chips
- 9 bronze 3 point chips
- 16 bronze 1 point chips
- 1 rulebook

Missing anything?
Email us at hello@cmyk.games

Credits

Original Game Design: Takashi Ishida

Updated Game Design: Richard Garfield

Creative Director: Alex Hague

Art: Angela Kirkwood

Graphic Design: Elizabeth Goodspeed, Janet Delavan

Additional Design and Development:
Skaff Elias, James Nathan Spencer, Justin Vickers

Lead Writer: Sophie Abromowitz

Publisher: CMYK

Manufacturer: Strom MFG

Thanks: Maisy Hatchard, Bryan Bornmueller,
Ted Werner, and the Magical Athlete playtesting
community

Watch how to play at
cmyk.games/ma